

Publication: Botswana Gazette - Business

Page: 15

Title: Employment Act. According to Meropa, a

Reach: 5,000

Publish date: 18 Feb 2026

AVE: P 2,975.00

Author: IMPLEMENTATION SUBJECT MATTER EXPERT
BMWU ON FEBRUARY

THE BOTSWANA GAZETTE WEDNESDAY 18 FEBRUARY 2026

NEWS

PAGE 15

DE BEERS GROUP

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)-DE BEERS
VOCATIONAL TRAINING INSTITUTE
IMPLEMENTATION SUBJECT MATTER EXPERT

BACKGROUND AND OBJECTIVES

De Beers will establish the De Beers Vocational Training Institute (DVTI) as part of the transformative agreement signed between the two parties in February 2025. This milestone marks a bold new chapter in the longstanding partnership and supports Botswana's national development ambitions. The vocational training institute will unlock opportunities through skills development in the diamond industry in support of Botswana's aspirations to transition to a high-income economy by 2036. The scope of the training institute will be limited to sorting, grading, evaluation, commercial, cutting and polishing. De Beers aims to closely match training offerings by the planned vocational institute to industry requirements.

Therefore, engaging an Implementation Subject Matter Expert shall bridge the gap between technical teams and operations to ensure translation of the DVTI vision to reality. DVTI shall be established as a national skills platform that sets standards, enables progression and selectively delivers high-impact training by December 2027.

SCOPE OF WORK

- Define the Operating and Sustainability model consistent with study findings from a recently concluded study (findings to be awaited)
- Successfully implement DVTI consistent with the finalised Operating and Sustainability model
- Identify, select and appoint qualified required technical subject matter experts to deliver DVTI workstreams
- Manage and account for milestones deliveries by technical teams. Project management capability, tracking and monitoring tool/s are a requirement
- Responsible for the supervision, reporting, troubleshooting and problem solving across all DVTI deliverables
- Lead successful deployment of systems, technologies and processes in alignment with business requirements and best practice

De Beers therefore invites bids from interested organisations/consultancy firms that believe they have the skills and technical capability to implement a training centre to submit to the below email address and ensure that evidence and references of past related works and/or performance (if any) is included. All companies based outside Botswana should indicate and explore partnership with a local organisation or company.

Note that submissions are requested on a non-committal basis and meant to assist De Beers to assess suitability to offer services. Shortlisting and evaluation will be made on the most suitable proposal received.

The selected service provider is to perform all work in full compliance with the company's Business Integrity Policy for the duration of the service.

COMPLIANCE REQUIREMENTS

De Beers operates within a Precious Stones Protected area. All companies and their employees involved in delivery of the service will be required to undergo a security and background clearance process and will be subject to all De Beers internal security and supplier registration procedures, including but not limited to Safety, Health and Environment, Business Integrity, and Anti Money Laundering considerations.

SUBMISSIONS

All submissions should be sent via email and titled **EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) - DE BEERS VOCATIONAL TRAINING INSTITUTE IMPLEMENTATION SUBJECT MATTER EXPERT** and must be emailed to [DBGSSProcurement@debeersgroup.com](mailto:&DBGSSProcurement@debeersgroup.com) no later than **4PM(CAT) 27 February 2026**. Late submissions, physical submissions, facsimile, telephone, or telefaxed submissions will not be accepted.

LIMITATIONS

This is an Expression of Interest (EOI) only; it is not a procurement document nor is it a request for tender. The information contained in this EOI is intended for information purposes only to assist interested parties in assessing whether to respond to such request. No representation or warranty express is made by De Beers or any of its agents, as to the accuracy or completeness of such information. Neither De Beers nor its agents will be responsible for, and hereby expressly disclaim, any and all liability for any errors, omissions or inaccuracies in connection therewith. In its response to this EOI, the respondent must disclose to De Beers, any potential conflict of interest that might compromise this process. If such a conflict of interest does exist, De Beers may, at its discretion, refuse to consider the response in question.

from page 14

Employment Act. According to Meropa, a multi-stakeholder agreement in August 2025 ensured outstanding salaries were advanced and employees received retrenchment notices with exit medical assessments.

DENIAL

"Meropa has never abandoned its employees. We have consistently engaged unions and authorities to safeguard salaries and benefits while managing contractual challenges with Minergy Coal," the company emphasized. Meropa's position stems from a statement by BMWU on February 9 this year asserting that the company had "dumped" its workers for a new venture.

WORKERS STRANDED

"Botswana Mine Workers Union (BMWU) expresses its profound concern and outrage with Meropa Resources for leaving workers stranded at Masama Coal Mine after curtailment production and refusing to pay their accrued salaries from August 2025 to date including their terminal benefits. Meropa Resources has effectively rejected its responsibility and legal duty to pay its employees under their employment contracts," the union stated.

REFUSING TO PAY

"Meropa Resources, the sub-contracting company of Minergy Coal Limited, has refused and subsequently failed to honor its contractual obligations following its work stoppage on the 14th of February 2025," BMWU added.

"Meropa Resources, cannot be engaged by MMG-Khoemacau Copper Mine, when it has unresolved labour compliance issues pending at Masama Coal Mine"

LICENSING CONDITION

"Recently, at the grounding breaking ceremony of MMG-Khoemacau Mine expansion project, the Minister of Minerals and Energy, Bogolo Kenewendo, noted the need to strengthen labour law compliance along the mining supply chains and making labour compliance a licensing condition for mineral rights holders. Emphasis was on the protection of workers engaged by subcontractors at Khoemacau - MMG," the union stressed.

UNRESOLVED LABOUR COMPLIANCE

"Considering the Minister's warning, Meropa Resources, cannot be engaged by MMG-Khoemacau Copper Mine, when it has unresolved labour compliance issues pending at Masama Coal Mine. It will be highly irregular and unlawful in terms of the amended Mines and Mineral Act, for a company with unresolved labour compliance issues to be granted a license and/or contract to continue work with unresolved issues," BMWU argued.

OBLIGATIONS NOT COMPROMISED

Responding to BMWU, Meropa maintains that any new initiatives, including collaborations with Khoemacau, will not compromise its obligations to former Masama Coal Mine employees.

